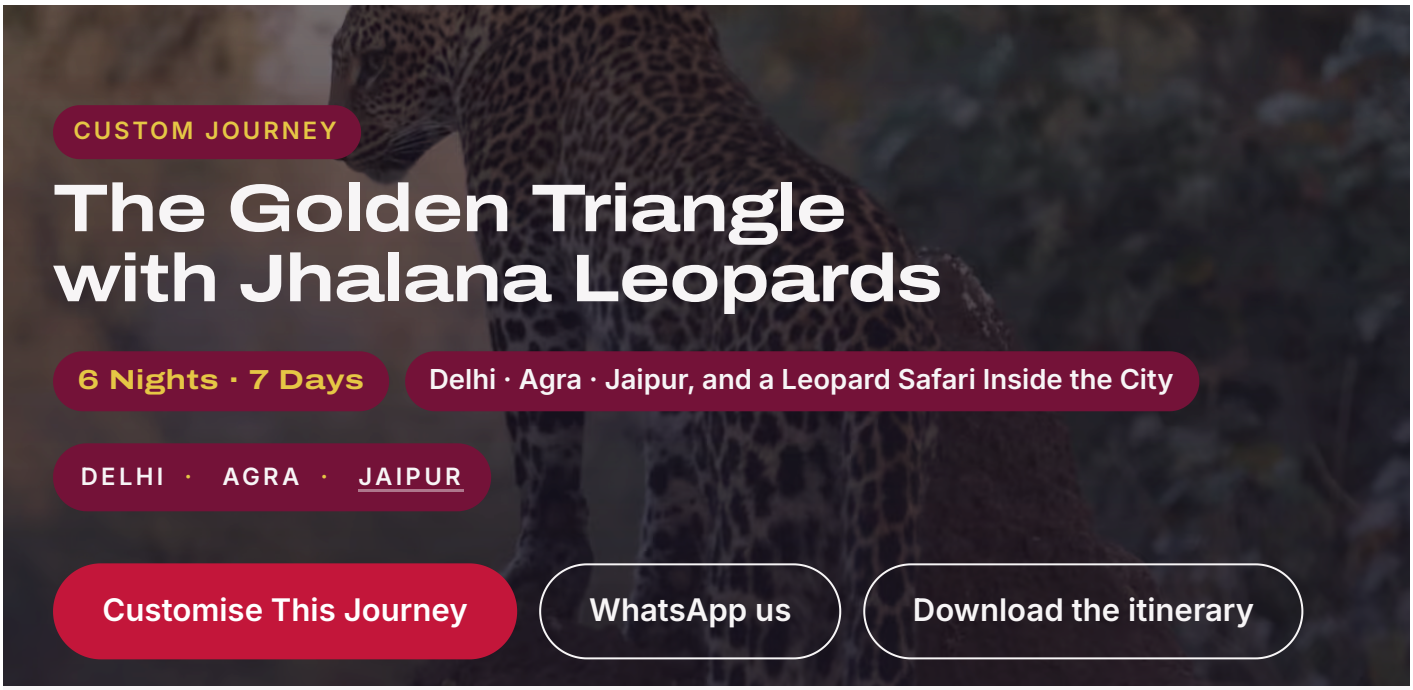
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CUSTOM JOURNEY

The Golden Triangle with Jhalana Leopards

6 Nights · 7 Days Delhi · Agra · Jaipur, and a Leopard Safari Inside the City

DELHI · AGRA · JAIPUR

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DURATION
6 Nights · 7 Days

ROUTE
Delhi → Jaipur

PACE
Moderate

BEST SEASON
October to March

IDEAL FOR
First-Timers, Couples, Families

Step into a land where Mughal emperors built monuments to love, maharajas ruled from pink sandstone palaces, and leopards still prowl the scrubland on the edge of a royal capital. This is the classic Golden Triangle — Delhi, Agra and Jaipur — with one addition that changes the character of the week: a full day at the Jhalana Leopard Reserve, a rocky forest inside Jaipur's city limits that has one of the highest leopard densities anywhere in India.

Seven days, three cities, and a single base in Jaipur for the last three nights, so the safaris come at the end of the trip rather than as a detour from it. It is history, heritage and a genuine wildlife encounter in one week, and an ideal first introduction to the country.

Journey Highlights

- **Complete** the Golden Triangle — Delhi, Agra and Jaipur — the circuit most first journeys to India are built on.
- **See** the Taj Mahal twice, at sunset on arrival and again at sunrise, when the marble takes its colour from the sky and the crowds are thinnest.
- **Track** leopards at Jhalana, a rocky scrub forest inside Jaipur's city limits with one of the highest leopard densities in India.
- **Double** your chances with two dedicated safaris, at dawn and in the golden hour before dusk, when the leopards are most active.
- **Unpack** once in Jaipur for three nights, and explore the Pink City from a single base.
- **Balance** Mughal architecture, Rajput heritage and genuine wildlife in one seven-day week.

Itinerary at a Glance

DAY	DESTINATION	SIGNATURE EXPERIENCE
Day 01	Delhi	Arrival and an orientation drive past India Gate
Day 02	Delhi	Old and New Delhi — Red Fort, Jama Masjid, Qutub Minar, Humayun's Tomb
Day 03	Delhi to Agra	Agra Fort, then the Taj Mahal at sunset
Day 04	Agra to Jaipur	Sunrise at the Taj, Fatehpur Sikri en route
Day 05	Jaipur	Amer Fort, City Palace, Jantar Mantar and the bazaars

DAY	DESTINATION	SIGNATURE EXPERIENCE
Day 06	Jaipur	Morning and evening leopard safaris at Jhalana
Day 07	Departure	Onward from Jaipur airport or station

Day by Day

Expand all

> Some day descriptions are drafted from the published route and are awaiting the operator's confirmed copy.

Day 01 Delhi — Arrival in the Capital

Met on arrival and taken to your hotel. Depending on the hour, an orientation drive past India Gate and Rashtrapati Bhavan, the presidential palace at the head of Lutyens' avenue — a first look at the city where ancient history and modern India sit on top of one another.

Overnight in Delhi

Day 02 Delhi — Old and New

Old Delhi first: the Red Fort, a UNESCO World Heritage Site; the great courtyard of the Jama Masjid; and a rickshaw ride through the lanes of Chandni Chowk, which is the fastest way to understand how the old city works. In the afternoon, New Delhi — the Qutub Minar, the serene garden tomb of Humayun, and a drive past the Lotus Temple and Akshardham.

Overnight in Delhi

Day 03 Agra — The Taj at Sunset

Drive — 3 to 4 hours by the Yamuna Expressway

South to Agra along the expressway. After check-in, Agra Fort — red sandstone above the Yamuna, a UNESCO site and the seat of the Mughal court before Delhi. Then the Taj Mahal in the last light of the day, the first of two visits, because a building this celebrated deserves to be seen at more than one hour.

Overnight in Agra

Day 04 Agra to Jaipur — Sunrise, then Fatehpur Sikri

Drive — 4 to 5 hours

Up early for the Taj at sunrise, when the marble goes from grey to rose to white and the gardens are almost empty. Breakfast, and then the road west to Jaipur, stopping at Fatehpur Sikri — Akbar's red-sandstone capital, built in the 1570s and abandoned within a generation, and left almost exactly as it was. Check in to your Jaipur hotel, which is home for the next three nights.

Explore Jaipur →

Overnight in Jaipur

Day 05 Jaipur — Amer Fort and the Pink City

The morning at Amer Fort, its ramparts rising out of the Aravalli hills, with the drive up to the gate by jeep. Then the City Palace, the stone instruments of the Jantar Mantar observatory, and the honeycomb facade of the Hawa Mahal, which is best photographed from the street. The evening is for the bazaars — textiles, gemstones and the handicrafts Jaipur has traded for three centuries.

Explore Jaipur →

Overnight in Jaipur

Day 06 Jhalana — Leopards at Dawn and Dusk

Jaipur's wildest secret is minutes from the centre. Jhalana Leopard Reserve is a rugged, rocky forest with one of the highest densities of leopards in India, and today is given to it entirely. The morning safari leaves at first light, with naturalist guides tracking pugmarks and alarm calls; leopards bask on the rock outcrops, and hyena, jungle cat, nilgai and more than a hundred bird species share the ground. A long break in the middle of the day, then out again for the evening drive, when the light is gold and the leopards are at their most active.

Overnight in Jaipur

Day 07 Jaipur — Departure

A leisurely breakfast and time for last purchases before the transfer to Jaipur airport or railway station for your onward journey — with royal palaces, the Taj at two hours of the day, and a face-to-face encounter with the leopards of Jhalana behind you.

Explore Jaipur →

Departure

What's included

- Accommodation — two nights Delhi, one night Agra, three nights Jaipur, in heritage or deluxe hotels of your choice
- Private air-conditioned vehicle for all transfers and sightseeing
- Two Jhalana Leopard Reserve safaris — jeep, forest permits and naturalist guide
- Monument entry fees and an English-speaking local guide
- Daily breakfast

Typical inclusions for a journey of this shape. The final list is confirmed in your custom quote.

Practical notes

Best time to visit

October to March — pleasant weather for the cities, and the best safari sightings at Jhalana. The reserve stays open through the summer, but the cities do not reward it.

Getting there

Arrive at Delhi (DEL); depart from Jaipur (JAI), which has direct connections to the metros and a growing set of international flights.

Sightings

Two safaris in a reserve this dense give a real chance of a leopard. We never promise one — the forest, and the city it sits inside, are worth the day on their own.

Pace

Moderate. Two driving days of three to five hours, an early start for the sunrise Taj and another for the dawn safari, with free evenings between.